

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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WHO CROSS THE THRESHOLD OF OUR HOMES?



OUR THEME

- **WHO CROSSES (transverses) THE THRESHOLD OF OUR HOMES?**
- **Meaning who comes through the doorway of our homes**
- **A Threshold means** a doorstep or the entrance or place or point of entering or beginning:
- **A threshold** is usually a strip of wood or stone forming the bottom of a doorway into a house or room.

A HOME

- * Is a place where one lives especially as a member of a family or household. It's also the place we feel most comfortable, loved, and protected — where we most feel at home. Home is many things to many people.
- * Most people feel safe and happy at home, even if it's not perfect.
- * It's easy to find somewhere to live, but it's tough to make a real home.
- * **We should be thankful for the homes or places that we live in** even if they are not permanent or owned by us.

A home is more than a house

- * Homes are a place that memories are made, where we are surrounded by the humblest of belongings that make us satisfied, decorated with personal touches and sentimental items that reflect our personality and style, where you begin each day, and where we rest our head each night.
- * Home is a safe-haven and a comfort zone.
- * A place to live with our families and pets and enjoy with friends.
- * A place to build memories as well as a place from which we build our future.
- * A place where we can truly just be ourselves.
- * **This is the difference between a house and a home.**

I have often observed that families allow people to come into their homes and some staying for various periods of time who are not in harmony with the principles and values of the family.

- * This often disrupts the atmosphere of the home and can bring tension between spouses.

Culturally

- * Taking into consideration the cultural aspects of obligation to immediate and extended families and of honoring of elderly village leaders and those who are holding office in Government positions it is difficult to know what to do in this kind of situation.
- * But there are some things that we can look at to bring into this kind of situation to help your home and family.

OUR MESSAGE:

■ BEING DILIGENT AS TO WHO CROSSES THE THRESHHOLD OF OUR HOMES

- * Being diligent about those who enter your home
- * Who do we innocently allow to come into your homes?
- * What kind of people are they?
- * Who are those that visits you?
- * Who 'hangs out' in your home?
- * Does your home attract certain kinds of people and what would be the reason for that?
- * Maybe it is for a good reason such as a place where help and encouragement are found.
- * BUT IT SHOULD NOT BE A HOME known for the gathering of those who are critical and complaining of others.
- * WE NEED TO MAKE CERTAIN THAT OUR HOME IS NOT A GATHERING POINT FOR THOSE WHO ARE CRITICAL AND COMPLAINING.
- * We should not allow any person to bring this kind of talk into our homes.
Proverbs 17:9 Whoever covers an offense seeks love, but he who repeats a matter separates close friends. ESV
Proverbs 17:4 Wrongdoers eagerly listen to gossip; liars pay close attention to slander. NLT
Proverbs 15:28 The heart of the godly thinks carefully before speaking; the mouth of the wicked overflows with evil words. NLT
James 4:11 Don't speak evil against each other, dear brothers and sisters. If you criticize and judge each other, then you are criticizing and judging God's law. But your job is to obey the law, not to judge whether it applies to you. NLT
- * What about those who have habits, like smoking, drinking, drugs, and are known to engage in evil practices which are directly opposed to what you and your family hold to as being Godly.
- * Should we ALLOW such persons to bring the spirit of these things into our homes?
- * SHOULDN'T WE SET SOME simple but Godly guidelines for our homes and ask those entering to respect your wishes.

Personal Testimony

- /// Our home in Papua New Guinea was always open to people to come and visit and eat or stay with us but we had to set simple standards for all those living in our home.
 - /// Things like not allowing differences and tensions between those in the home to go unresolved and unreconciled for more than a day. They were encouraged to quickly resolve those things amongst themselves, otherwise I would have to assist them to do so. Respect for one another in the home needed to be maintained.
 - /// Not allowing swearing, profound language and anger to be brought into our house.
Proverbs 4:24 Avoid all perverse talk; stay away from corrupt speech. NLT
 - /// WE SET SOME RULES / GUIDELINES IN OUR HOME SO AS TO PROTECT AND PRESERVE THE GOOD SPIRIT AND ATMOSPHERE THAT EXISTED IN OUR HOME.
 - /// TOO OFTEN THERE IS A LACK OF DISCIPLINE IN THIS AREA OF LIVING and things are brought into our homes which subtly affect our spouses without us realising it until later on it surfaces.
Proverbs 15:21 The empty-headed treat life as a plaything; the perceptive grasp its meaning and make a go of it. THE MESSAGE:
 - /// WE SHOULD SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR OF OUR HOMES.
 - /// WE SHOULD NOT ALLOW THOSE PERSONS WHO BRING WRONG THOUGHTS, ABUSIVE LANGUAGE, STRONG DRINK, GOSSIP, REPEATING RUMOURS, SPEAKING EVIL OF OTHERS INTO OUR HOMES.
 - /// WE SHOULD BE GUARDING OUR HOMES.
 - /// BEING DILIGENT AS TO WHO CROSSES THE THRESHHOLD OF OUR HOMES.
- Amen – Ps Barry